Filter by column values while reading using read.csv in R [duplicate]

Asked 6 years, 5 months ago Modified 6 years, 5 months ago Viewed 16k times Part of R Language Collective

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This question already has answers here:
skip some rows in read.csv in R (4 answers)
Closed 6 years ago.

I have a huge dataset in the form of a txt file with values separated by semi colons and has close to 2M rows. I need data only corresponding to particular dates in the first col. Sample input is shown below:

```
Date;Time;Global_active_power;Global_reactive_power;Voltage;Global_intensity;Sub_metering
16/12/2006;17:24:00;4.216;0.418;234.840;18.400;0.000;1.000;17.000
16/12/2006;17:25:00;5.360;0.436;233.630;23.000;0.000;1.000;16.000
16/12/2006;17:26:00;5.374;0.498;233.290;23.000;0.000;2.000;17.000
```

Please help me to filter data corresponding to two dates say 1/2/2007 and 2/2/2007

r

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edited Dec 9, 2016 at 19:10
Jaap
80.4k 34 181 192

asked Dec 9, 2016 at 19:06
Sundararaman P
321 1 6 12

It is relatively easy to drop columns in a `read.csv` call through the col.classes argument. If your data is ordered by date, you could figure out the set of rows you want to read manually and then use the skip and nrows argument to read in those rows. – Imo Dec 9, 2016 at 19:18

Maybe some ideas here: stackoverflow.com/questions/6592219/read-csv-from-specific-row/... – MrFlick Dec 9, 2016 at 19:20

1 Also, if this dataset gets close to eating up your available memory, you should take a look at `fread` in `data.table` or `read.csv.raw` / `read.chunk` in `iotools`. – Imo Dec 9, 2016 at 19:21

Pretty much the same question as this: stackoverflow.com/questions/24006475/... – MrFlick Dec 9, 2016 at 19:22

1 Answer

Sorted by: Highest score (default)

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Here's a good answer on filtering during data import: https://stackoverflow.com/a/15967406/1152809

Basically, you need to use sqldf to filter during import. Here's something like what you need:

```
install.packages("sqldf")
library(sqldf)
df <- read.csv.sql("sample.csv", "select *, from file where Date = '01/02/2007' or Date
= '2/2/2007 ", sep=";")
```

However, I haven't tested this because you didn't give us a dput of your data. Take a look at this post for info on how to do a good post on R.

Your dates are strings, so they can use the above. However, if you want to use date-specific functions like BETWEEN, you're going to need to change them to the correct format. Here's a sample:

```
df <- read.csv.sql("sample.csv", "select *, strftime('%d/%m/%Y', Date) as DateFormated
from file where DateFormatted >= 1/2/2007 and DateFormatted <= 2/2/2007 ", sep=";")
```

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edited May 23, 2017 at 12:08
Community Bot
1 1

answered Dec 9, 2016 at 19:23
Travis Heeter
12.7k 13 86 125

2 Thank you Travis. It worked input <- read.csv.sql("household_power_consumption.txt","select * from file where Date = '1/1/2007' or Date = '2/2/2007' ",sep=";") – Sundararaman P Dec 10, 2016 at 6:40

What's with the comma after `select *` ? – NoName Jun 26, 2021 at 22:31